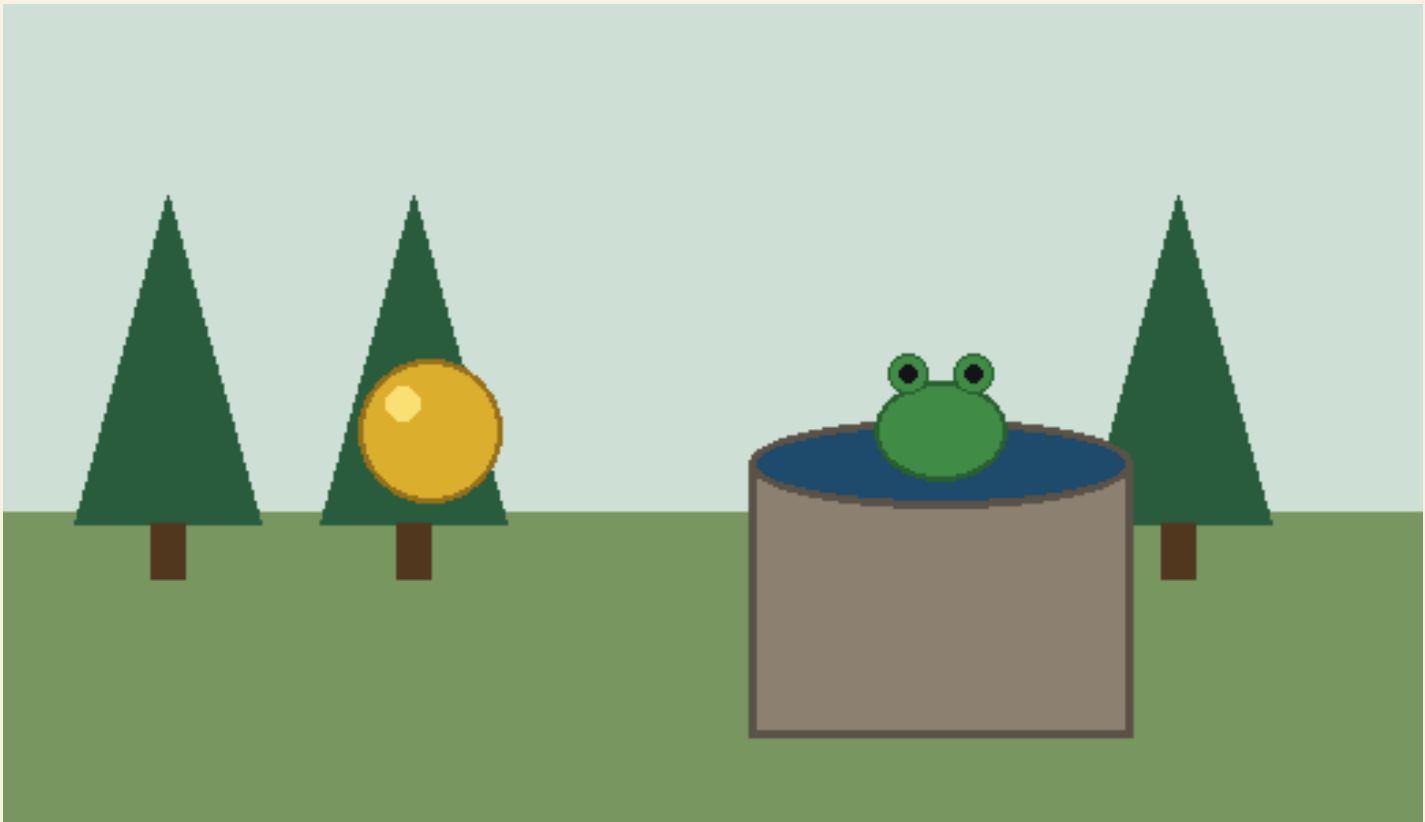


The Frog-King

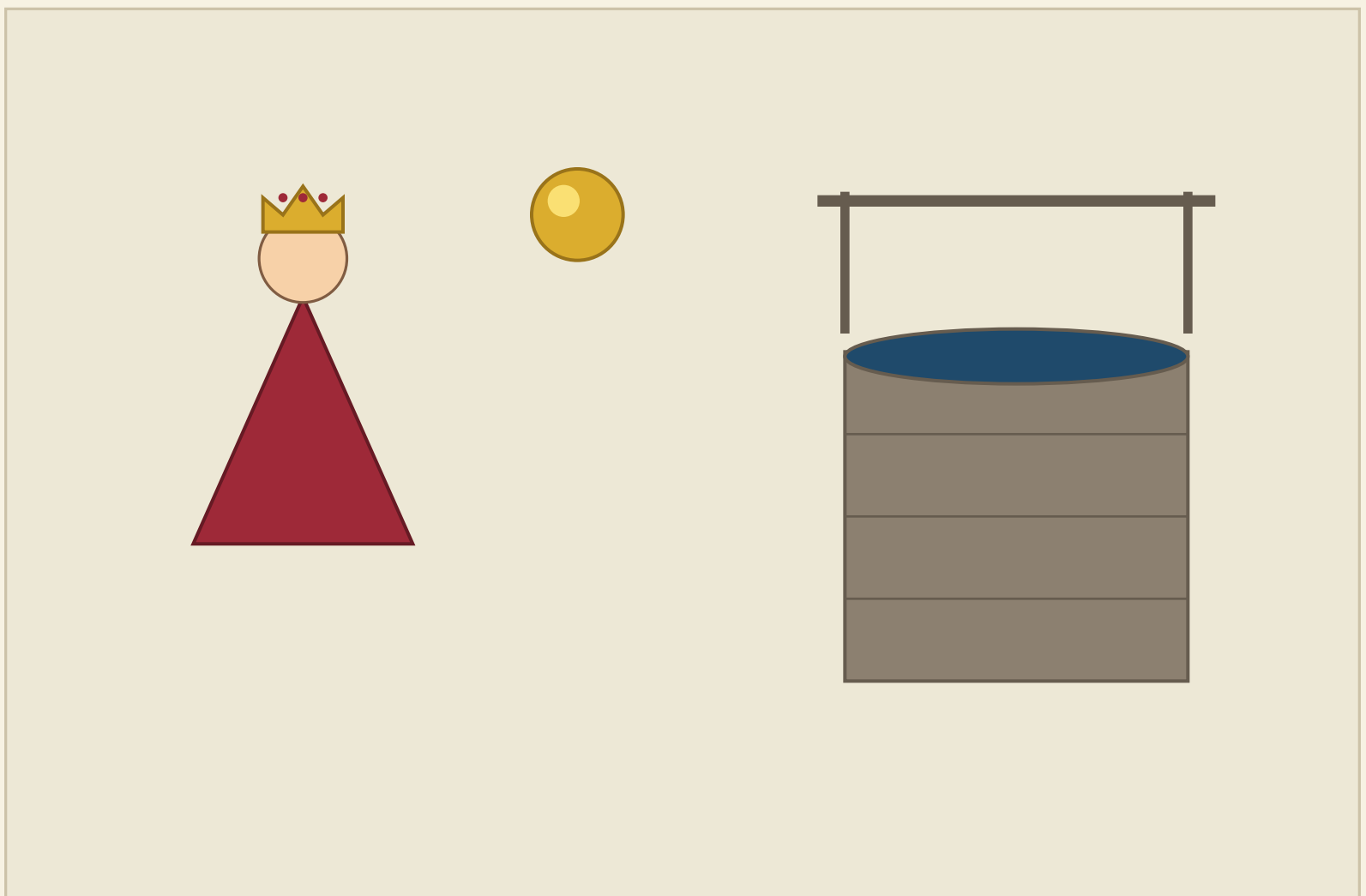
An abridged retelling of the Brothers Grimm fairy tale



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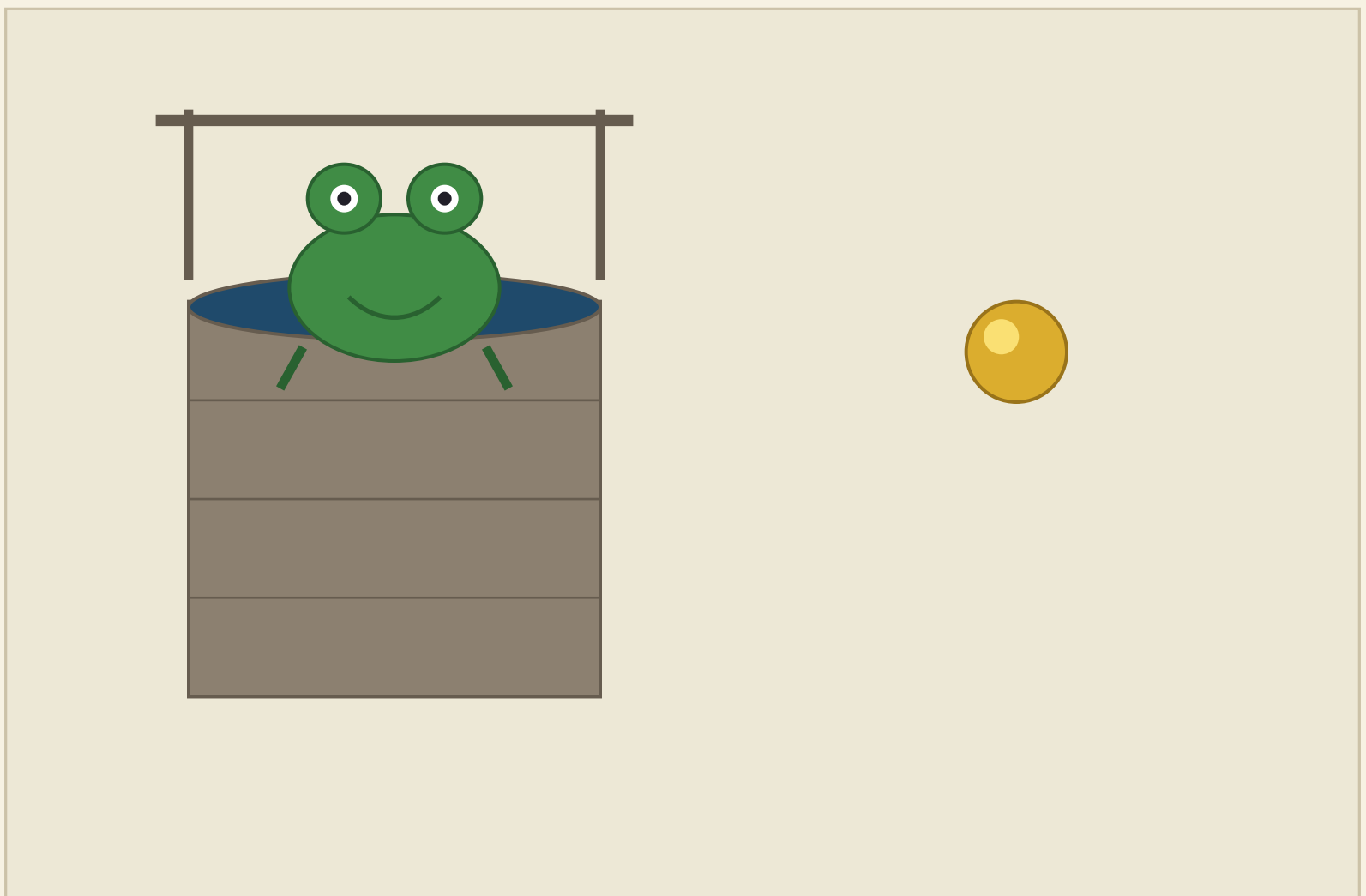
1. The golden ball

In the old time, when wishing still helped, there lived a King whose youngest daughter was so beautiful that the sun itself was astonished whenever it shone upon her face. Near the King's castle lay a great, dark forest, and in the forest, beneath an old lime-tree, there was a deep well. When the day was hot, the young Princess went out into the forest and sat by the cool well; and when she was bored she took a golden ball, threw it up on high, and caught it again; and this was her favourite plaything.



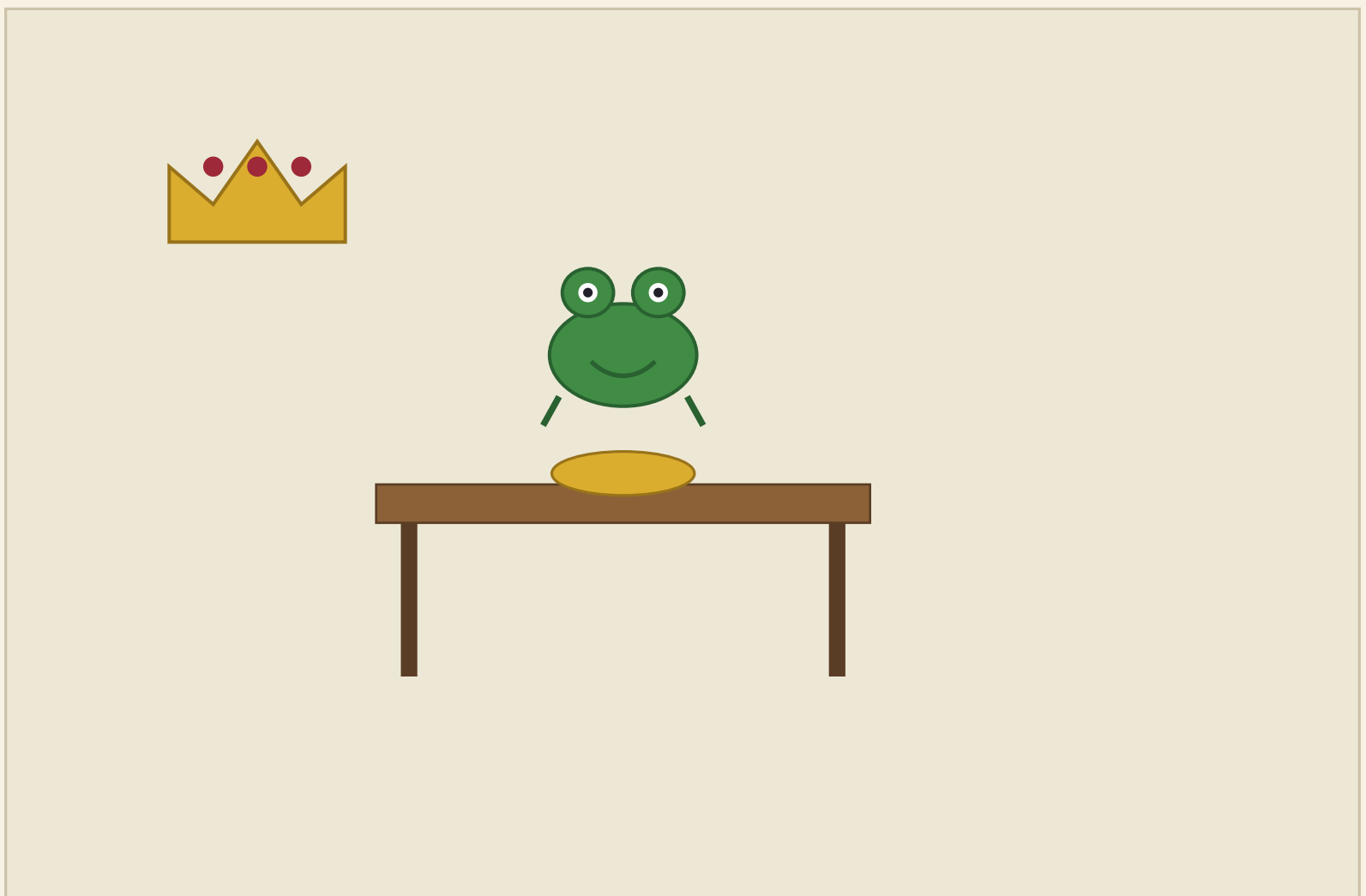
2. A promise at the well

One day the golden ball did not fall into her little hand, but slipped past and rolled straight into the deep water. The Princess wept, and could not be comforted. Then a voice cried to her: "What ails you, King's daughter?" She looked round, and saw a Frog stretching his thick, ugly head from the water. "I weep for my golden ball, which has fallen into the well." The Frog said, "If you will love me, and let me be your companion, and eat from your little golden plate, I will bring your ball again." She promised, and the Frog dived down and brought the golden ball up in his mouth.



3. A knock at the castle door

The next day, as the Princess sat at dinner with the King and all the court, something came creeping up the marble stairs, and knocked at the door, crying, "Princess, youngest Princess, open the door for me!" It was the Frog. The King saw that she was troubled, and asked what she feared. When she told him of her promise at the well, the King said, "That which you have promised must you perform. Go and let him in." So the Frog was set upon the table, and ate from her little golden plate beside her.



4. The spell is broken

When the Frog had eaten, he asked to rest, and the Princess carried him up to her room. As he lay upon her soft pillow through the night, the enchantment fell away. In the morning, where the Frog had been, there stood a young Prince with kind and beautiful eyes. He told her that a wicked witch had bewitched him, and that she alone could have set him free. And so the Princess and the Prince became dear and faithful friends, and there was great joy throughout the King's castle.

